

Clouds; they float, they fly, they're SUPER – who needs a Marvel franchise. I remember being enthralled by clouds as a kid. Just lying on my back, which as a kid you can pretty much do anywhere, anytime – not so easy socially or physically these days – and marvel as they twisted and turned and danced in the heavens, and became whatever you imagined them becoming. What other crazy thing in life can do this magic trick? They grew they shrank, merging together, ripping spectacularly apart, they were alive!

I used to have competitions to see who could find the most fantastical shape, the most bizarre creature in the sky – you just had to wait it for a bit while the clouds decided what they would become. Maybe a dragon with huge billowing wings sweeping in from the horizon, or perhaps a bearded giant stumbling across the skies. My friend Mac was hopeless at it. But being a dog his job was mainly to come up every now and again in a huge body wag and prompt me on with his wet nose.

Clouds were joyful, white, fluffy, soft, cottony balls that floated in the imagination and the skies. Most of the time. Sometimes they became sinister. They stretched into dark, wet, slow driving, cold evil fog. Madden Plains from Wollongong to Sydney would become a nightmare. Dad would have to drive 20 miles an hour for what seemed an eternity. He told me we were driving through fog, mist, the clouds innards. It was like that dragon with the huge billowing wings had swallowed us and we were being digested. It had swallowed others that all traced in slo-mo the digestive track with headlight torches and orange blinking eyes, trapped in their cautious cars. Slowly we inched towards Sydney – which seemed to me at the time to be the dragon's bum hole.